

Two minor pieces versus a rook

Chess Math

THE IDEA

A bishop and knight total about six units, compared with a rook's five. Their coordination often makes them strong in a crowded middlegame. A rook may become more effective when open files and widely separated pawns appear.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If you exchange a rook and two pawns for two minor pieces, you give 7 units for 6. That one-unit deficit may be offset by activity, but it is a real cost that must be justified.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What changes when the board contains pawns on both wings and few blockers?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The rook can switch wings quickly and attack distant pawns. Minor pieces may struggle to cover both sides. Material formulas need an assessment of routes and targets.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Material composition matters as much as the total.